

# 8th Grade English Language Arts

Teacher Manual · M/J Language Arts 3 (Florida 1001070) · 2026–2027 · 6 Modules · 36 Instructional Weeks

**Facilitator copy. Contains answer keys, rubrics, and grading guidance. Do not publish to students.**

This manual documents the course as it was actually built. Every module, lesson type, assessment, and standard named below was read out of the finished course, not assumed. Anything the build does not yet settle is marked **[VERIFY]** rather than guessed.

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# 1. HOW THIS COURSE WORKS

## A typical lesson

Every interactive lesson page (Monday and Wednesday grammar, Tuesday and Thursday literature) follows the same shape. Using Week 0's Literature 1 lesson ("Hear It, Read It, Meet the Speaker") as a concrete walk-through:

1. **Header strip** — quarter, module, lesson number, anchor text, and the module theme, so a student always knows where they are.
2. **Today's Focus** — one teaching paragraph (prose, not bullets) naming the single idea the lesson turns on.
3. **Objectives** — two "I will be able to..." statements.
4. **A quick check-in widget** (ow-reflect) — no wrong answer, opens the lesson.
5. **The reading or worked example** — the text itself (public domain texts appear in full; in-copyright texts are referenced with "read in your own copy" plus short fair-use lines) and, where relevant, a Word Study ow-flip vocabulary card.
6. **A self-check widget** (ow-select, sometimes a <details> commit-then-reveal) — immediate, ungraded, ties directly to the lesson's focus.
7. **What you'll do next** and **Before you go** — points to the graded item the lesson feeds and previews tomorrow.

None of this produces a submission or a grade. The graded touchpoint for the week lives in the separate Daily Practice, Quick Write, and Friday Check-up assignments described below.

## A typical week

| DAY / SEGMENT           | WHAT THE STUDENT DOES                                                                      | GRADED?                     | TIER                 |
|-------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------|----------------------|
| Monday — Grammar 1      | Interactive lesson (technique + imitation, e.g. rhyme/stanza, sentence variety)            | No                          | Tier 1<br>(ungraded) |
| Tuesday — Literature 1  | Interactive lesson: reading, retell, or craft study; Word Study vocabulary                 | No                          | Tier 1<br>(ungraded) |
| Wednesday — Grammar 2   | Interactive lesson (second technique/imitation pass)                                       | No                          | Tier 1<br>(ungraded) |
| Thursday — Literature 2 | Interactive lesson: reading, copywork, or imitation practice                               | No                          | Tier 1<br>(ungraded) |
| Friday — Check-up       | Canvas Discussion: post + reply, tied to the week's central question                       | Yes                         | Tier 2               |
| Weekly — Daily Practice | Handwritten notebook (copywork, marking, images), submitted as a photo upload              | Yes, completion             | Tier 1               |
| Weekly — Quick Write    | Typed M365 Word document (Composition), 100–300 words, scaffolds the module capstone       | Yes, completion/light       | Tier 1               |
| Ongoing — Memorization  | A passage from the current module, reviewed daily; recited only 4×/year (once per quarter) | Only at quarter recitations | Tier 1               |

## Major assessments (the year at a glance)

| MODULE             | ASSESSMENT                                                                     | TIER                | OUTPUT                                       | EST. GRADING TIME*                    |
|--------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------|----------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|
| M6, Week 0         | Poetry interlude ("Invictus") — no major submission                            | Tier 1/2            | Daily Practice + Quick Write + Check-up only | Batch, ~2 min/student                 |
| Module 1 — Emma    | Final Argumentative Essay + VR Highbury collage + Q1/Q2 recitation             | Tier 3              | 3–5 page essay                               | ~5 min/student (~41 hrs/500 students) |
| Module 2 — OOTSP   | Original short story (Lewis imitation) + VR scene + recitation                 | Tier 3              | 2–3 page story                               | ~5 min/student (~41 hrs)              |
| Module 3 — Whitman | Juxtaposition poem, performed under a VR night sky + full-poem recitation      | Tier 3<br>(lighter) | 6–12 line poem                               | ~2–3 min/student                      |
| Module 4 — LOTF    | Final Argumentative Essay (cites VR island scenes as evidence) + Q3 recitation | Tier 3              | 3–5 page essay                               | ~5 min/student (~41 hrs)              |

| MODULE                    | ASSESSMENT                                                                                                        | TIER              | OUTPUT                                                    | EST. GRADING TIME*                                  |
|---------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|
| Module 5 —<br>The Lottery | Original short story (Jackson imitation) + recitation —<br><b>compressed into 2 weeks</b>                         | <b>Tier 3</b>     | 1–2 page story                                            | ~5 min/student (~41 hrs, in<br>half the usual time) |
| Module 6 —<br>TKAM        | Analysis Project (Wk 4) + Creative Scene (Wk 9) + Final<br>Essay (Wk 9) + shared VR Maycomb + year-end recitation | <b>Tier 3 × 3</b> | Annotated chapter + essay; 1–<br>2 pg scene; 3–5 pg essay | ~12 min/student across all<br>three (~108 hrs)      |

\*Grading-time estimates are drawn from the build's own planning notes (ASSESSMENT\_OVERVIEW.md), scaled to a 500-student load; treat as planning estimates, not guarantees.

## 2. UNGRADED INTERACTIVES & THE INTRO/OUTRO WRAPPERS

### Ungraded interactive activities

Each lesson embeds one or two of the house widget engines: **ow-reflect** (no-wrong-answer check-in), **ow-select** (classify/spot-the-error, with instant per-row feedback), **ow-flip** (tap-to-reveal vocabulary cards), and a **commit-then-reveal** <details> block ("try it yourself, then compare"). These live on the GitHub-hosted lesson page, give the student immediate feedback, and **produce no submission and need no grading**. They are formation-by-practice, not busywork to chase: a student who skips one shows up indirectly, in weaker Quick Write or Check-up responses, not as a missing grade in your gradebook.

### Module Organizers (the Reading Journal)

Each module opens with a Module Organizer — an M365 Word document a student keeps across the whole module: the central question, Word Study vocabulary, the passages being memorized, and an evolving answer to the central question, updated at set checkpoints. It is **ungraded working notes**, collected at module checkpoints (not weekly), and it is where a student should be building the raw material their capstone essay or story will draw on.

### Module intro/outro wrappers

**These are Canvas Quizzes in survey mode, not narrative pages.** They ask the essential question first, a confidence rating, "what's still unclear," and a short virtue reflection — structured as questions specifically so the responses become sortable cohort data, not because a survey format is quicker to build.

**The highest-leverage move in the whole course:** spend 15–20 minutes per module triaging outro responses. Look for clusters of low confidence, the same "still unclear" item showing up across many students, or a student whose answer has not moved since the intro. Respond with a targeted announcement, an Ignite-AI-drafted nudge (Section 4), or an individual message — before the capstone is due, not after it comes back thin.

**[VERIFY]** Only Module 1 has a built Intro Wrapper file in the current build (Module 1 - Emma\Module 1 Intro Wrapper.md); confirm whether Modules 2–6 have their own intro wrappers before the course goes live, or whether the design intends only one course-opening intro wrapper.

### 3. AI & VR IN THIS COURSE (STUDENT-FACING)

#### AI

**This course's AI policy lives in the syllabus, not on individual lesson or assignment pages.** No Week 0–6 lesson, Quick Write, or essay page carries its own AI callout box; the stance is stated once, in the syllabus's "Appropriate Use of AI" section, and applies course-wide.

The policy itself: AI may support learning (explaining a concept differently, checking understanding, brainstorming) unless an assignment says otherwise. AI may never do the actual thinking or writing an assignment asks for — a reflection, an essay, or a discussion post must be genuinely the student's own. Submitting AI-generated text as one's own work is treated as an insincere attempt (the same standard applied to rushed, corrupted, or nonsense submissions) and should be named briefly by the student when used. Because this isn't restated per-assignment, plan to reinforce it verbally at the start of each major essay cycle — students will not see a fresh reminder on the essay page itself.

#### VR

VR is **platform-agnostic** throughout (build notes read "[Teacher: VR platform TBD]"; do not name a specific platform to students) and graded for **Tier 1 completion only**: did the student build the scene, not how polished it looks. Every VR build is later cited as evidence inside the module's essay, so a thin VR build tends to surface as a thin essay, not as a separate deduction. Students choose their own VR Location for solo work.

| MODULE      | WHAT STUDENTS BUILD                                                                                        | HOW IT'S USED                                                              |
|-------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Emma        | A Highbury room/space for one character, with three supporting quotations                                  | Cited as the essay's visual argument (Emma's self-perception vs. reality)  |
| OOTSP       | Key scene(s) from the student's own original story                                                         | Drafting/revision tool: does the VR build match the prose?                 |
| Whitman     | A night-sky setting for the performance                                                                    | The performance itself is the embodied argument                            |
| LOTF        | Three island locations: the Beach, Castle Rock, Simon's clearing                                           | Cited scene-by-scene as visual evidence of order → tyranny → transcendence |
| The Lottery | Optional: the "ordinary town" space                                                                        | Optional revision aid only; not required                                   |
| TKAM        | A shared Maycomb (schoolroom, town square, Radley house, courthouse), built and refined across all 9 weeks | Cited as evidence across all three TKAM projects                           |

## 4. USING IGNITE AI TO SUPPORT STUDENTS (TEACHER-FACING)

**[VERIFY] before relying on this section:** Ignite AI's exact feature names and availability vary by Canvas release and by what Optima has enabled on this instance. Confirm the current feature set before promising a capability to yourself mid-grading-week.

Used well, Ignite AI is what makes a 500:1 ratio feel personal. In every case below, **AI drafts, you decide:** read, edit, and own anything before it reaches a student or family.

- **Draft individualized feedback** on essay and story drafts, which you then edit into your own voice — faster Tier 3 turnaround on the same 5 essays/year, same human judgment.
- **Summarize outro-wrapper analytics and discussion threads** to find a module's sticking point fast (Section 2's 15–20 minute triage), especially useful before TKAM's triple-capstone week.
- **Surface students who need a nudge** — low confidence on an outro, a missed Daily Practice, a Quick Write that's gone quiet — and draft a warm check-in message you send yourself.
- **Generate practice variants** for a student who needs another rep on a Tier 1 skill (e.g., another sentence-imitation prompt after Golding's fragmented-sentence lesson).
- **Draft family communication**, especially ahead of the sensitive-content moments flagged in Section 13, and translate messages when helpful.

Govern every use with Section 8's coach-not-catch rule. AI is never used to surveil, rank, or auto-penalize a student.

## 5. GRADING CATEGORIES & CANVAS GRADEBOOK SETUP

### Grading categories (assignment groups)

| CATEGORY         | WEIGHT | WHAT'S IN IT                                                                                         |
|------------------|--------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Daily Practice   | 30%    | Weekly handwritten notebook (copywork, marking, grammar practice), photo upload, completion-graded   |
| Composition      | 25%    | Weekly Quick Writes, typed M365 documents, completion or light rubric                                |
| Major Works      | 30%    | The 5 capstone essays/stories + TKAM's Analysis Project & Creative Scene + all 4 quarter recitations |
| Friday Check-ups | 15%    | Weekly Canvas Discussion, Tier 2                                                                     |

These weights match the syllabus's published Assessment & Grading breakdown (30/25/30/15). The build's internal tier ratio (Tier 1 ≈60% of item count / Tier 3 ≈15% of item count) is a separate axis from these gradebook weights — both are correct at once.

### Step-by-step Canvas setup

1. Under **Grades** → **Assignment Groups**, create the four groups above and set their weights (30 / 25 / 30 / 15) so the total equals 100%.
2. For each Daily Practice and Quick Write assignment, set **Grading Type: Complete/Incomplete** unless the module page calls for a light points rubric.
3. Set Friday Check-up discussions to grade with the 3-band discussion rubric in Section 6.
4. Attach the standard essay rubric (Section 6) to every Major Works item as a native Canvas Rubric, so grading flows through SpeedGrader.
5. Mark module intro/outro wrappers as **Survey** quizzes (ungraded, but tracked for completion in the requirements view).
6. Set the course's late/missing policy to match the syllabus: no per-due-date penalty, a zero for anything incomplete at quarter's end, and a 10% deduction inside the final 14 days of a quarter.

### Gradebook map

| ITEM                                | ASSIGNMENT GROUP      | GRADING METHOD                                          |
|-------------------------------------|-----------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| Daily Practice (weekly)             | Daily Practice        | Completion (3-band, Section 6)                          |
| Quick Write (weekly)                | Composition           | Completion / light rubric                               |
| Friday Check-up (weekly)            | Friday Check-ups      | Discussion rubric (Section 6)                           |
| 5 capstone essays/stories           | Major Works           | Native Canvas Rubric (Section 6)                        |
| TKAM Analysis Project               | Major Works           | Native Canvas Rubric, light variant                     |
| TKAM Creative Scene                 | Major Works           | Native Canvas Rubric, craft variant                     |
| 4 quarter recitations               | Major Works           | Fluency rubric, completion-based (Section 6)            |
| VR builds (Emma, OOTSP, LOTF, TKAM) | not separately graded | Completion checklist; validated through the essay grade |
| Module intro/outro wrappers         | not graded            | Survey quiz; tracked via requirements view              |

Use the **module progress / requirements view** as your at-a-glance signal for who has (and hasn't) touched the ungraded scaffolding — widgets, wrappers, and the Organizer — without needing to grade any of it.

## 6. RUBRICS FOR EVERY TEACHER-GRADED ITEM

### Standard Major Works rubric (essays & imitative stories)

This is the rubric already built inline on each essay page (e.g. Module 6...Week 9\W9 Final Essay.html); paste it into Canvas as a native Rubric so it scores in SpeedGrader. Kept identical across Emma, OOTSP, LOTF, The Lottery, and TKAM's Final Essay so grading stays fast and consistent.

| CRITERION              | EXCELLENT                                                                      | PROFICIENT                                                    | DEVELOPING                                       | BEGINNING                                            |
|------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Thesis</b>          | Clear, arguable thesis answers the central question and guides the whole piece | Clear thesis, mostly sustained                                | Thesis present but vague or drifts               | No clear position, or the piece only summarizes plot |
| <b>Evidence</b>        | Specific, well-chosen textual (and where applicable, VR) evidence throughout   | Solid evidence, occasionally general                          | Some evidence, more assertion than support       | Little or no textual evidence                        |
| <b>Counterargument</b> | States the strongest objection fairly and answers it convincingly              | States and answers an objection, though not the strongest one | Objection stated but answered weakly or unfairly | No counterargument attempted                         |
| <b>Clarity</b>         | Precise, controlled prose; errors do not distract                              | Generally clear; occasional lapses                            | Readable but repeatedly unclear or error-heavy   | Difficult to follow                                  |

For OOTSP, The Lottery, and TKAM's Creative Scene (imitative works), swap "Thesis" for "**Imitation of Technique**" ("Does this clearly imitate the author's method, and is the model explicit?") and keep the other three criteria. For TKAM's Analysis Project, keep all four as written; the "central question" becomes the student's chosen chapter's argument.

### Daily Practice & Quick Write completion rubric

| COMPLETE                                       | PARTIAL                                      | NOT YET                                  |
|------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------|
| All required pieces present and done with care | One piece missing, or work that looks rushed | Not submitted, or only one piece present |

### Friday Check-up discussion rubric

The built pages describe this narratively rather than as a table (e.g., Module 1's Check-up: "you answer the question, cite a specific moment or line, include the reflection sentence, and reply substantively"). Use this 3-band version as the native Canvas Rubric:

| FULL CREDIT                                                                                                    | PARTIAL CREDIT                                                                | MISSING                                             |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|
| Answers the question, cites a specific line or moment by name, and includes a substantive reply to a classmate | Post is vague or under-cited, OR the reply is missing/superficial ("I agree") | No post, or a post with no textual reference at all |

### Recitation fluency rubric

**[VERIFY]:** the build's own planning notes leave this as an open item ("Design fluency rubric..." unchecked in ASSESSMENT\_OVERVIEW.md). Use the simple version below until the department finalizes one:

| FLUENT                                                                       | DEVELOPING                                          | NEEDS PRACTICE                                       |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| Accurate, audible, and paced naturally, with at most one self-corrected slip | Mostly accurate with some hesitation or a flat pace | Multiple errors, inaudible, or clearly not memorized |

**VR completion checklist**

For each VR item (Section 3's table): Was the required space/scene built? Is the required textual evidence identifiable in it (e.g., the three Highbury quotations, the three LOTF locations)? Is it referenced by name in the corresponding essay? A "yes" to the last question is your real signal — a thin VR build almost always shows up as a thin essay citation.

## 7. DISCUSSIONS, QUICK WRITES & INTERACTIVE ACTIVITIES: HOW TO RUN & GRADE

### By type

| TYPE                                      | SCORED HOW                        | TEACHER MOVE                                                                  |
|-------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| In-lesson widget (ow-reflect/select/flip) | Not scored; instant self-feedback | Nothing to grade; watch for patterns in Quick Write quality instead           |
| Friday Check-up (discussion)              | 3-band rubric, Section 6          | Batch-read weekly; drop 2–3 public model-comment replies naming good thinking |
| Daily Practice / Quick Write              | Completion / light rubric         | Scan for completion in a batch pass, ~30 sec/student                          |
| Recitation (4×/year)                      | Fluency rubric, Section 6         | Spot-listen; flag any student who is clearly unprepared for a brief re-record |
| Major Works capstone                      | 4-criterion rubric, Section 6     | Full read + SpeedGrader rubric; this is where your real feedback time goes    |
| VR build                                  | Completion checklist              | Rapid spot-check; validated through the essay                                 |

### Per-instance notes

| MODULE      | ITEM                              | FULL-CREDIT SHAPE                                                                                                              |
|-------------|-----------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| M6 Week 0   | Quick Write: metaphor explanation | Quotes a metaphor with stanza named; explains what circumstance it stands for in the student's own words; 5+ sentences         |
| Emma        | Final Essay                       | 3–5 pages; thesis on self-knowledge/moral growth; cites the VR collage as evidence; states and answers 2+ objections           |
| OOTSP       | Original short story              | 2–3 pages; imitates Lewis's sensory world-building; cites/uses the built VR scene in revision                                  |
| Whitman     | Juxtaposition poem                | 6–12 lines; two contrasting moments; repeated opening + a pivot; performed in VR                                               |
| LOTF        | Final Essay                       | 3–5 pages; thesis on order/civilization; explicitly names the Beach/Castle Rock/clearing VR scenes as evidence                 |
| The Lottery | Original short story              | 1–2 pages; imitates Jackson's compression and buried foreshadowing; due before Spring Break — watch this 2-week window closely |
| TKAM        | Analysis Project (Wk 4)           | One annotated chapter + 2–3 page analytical essay on character/setting/moral argument                                          |
| TKAM        | Creative Scene (Wk 9)             | 1–2 pages in Lee's voice (Scout narrating); uses shared VR Maycomb as reference                                                |
| TKAM        | Final Essay (Wk 9)                | 3–5 pages on justice/community/moral courage; integrates the Analysis Project and Creative Scene                               |

## 8. COACH, NOT CATCH

Your job is to move each student forward, not to build a case against them.

- Feedback names the next step, not just the error. Lead with what's working before the fix.
- Quick Writes are practice; allow a re-attempt when a student clearly missed the point rather than marking it done-wrong forever.
- Use outro-wrapper analytics and Ignite AI (Sections 2 & 4) to find students who need help early, then reach out — not to build a case against them.
- On suspected AI misuse or academic dishonesty (the syllabus's "insincere attempt" language): open a conversation first. Ask the student to talk through their thinking. Treat it as formation, not an accusation.
- Public discussion replies model good thinking; they highlight strong moments, never single out weak posts for public criticism.

## 9. WEEKLY ANNOUNCEMENT SCRIPTS

Because this course is asynchronous, your weekly announcement is your main visible presence. Clone the template below for any week; a few of the course's real weeks are drafted after it.

### Template (any week)

Hi everyone — this week we're in **[Module/Week]**, working on **[the week's focus]**. The one thing not to miss: **[a due item or a tricky concept]**, due by **[date]**. [One warm, specific line of encouragement.] Reach out anytime — I'm at office hours **[day/time]** and always a message away.

### Week 0 → TKAM transition (Module 6)

This week is a short one: a single poem, Henley's "Invictus," about staying yourself when circumstances aren't your choosing. No VR, no memorization — just read closely and post your Check-up. Next week we open *To Kill a Mockingbird* and spend nine weeks in Maycomb. Keep this week's question in your back pocket; you'll meet it again in Atticus.

### Pre-major-essay reminder (any essay module, ~1 week out)

Your [Module] essay is due **[date]**. By now you should have a thesis, at least one objection drafted, and your VR [scene] built. If any of those is missing, that's this week's priority, not new reading. Bring a rough draft to study hall on **[day]** and I'll help you sharpen it before it's due.

### Mid-module check-in (low-confidence follow-up)

If your confidence on last week's reflection was low, you are not behind — you're exactly where a lot of your classmates are. [Name the specific sticking point from the outro data.] Come to study hall this week, or send me a message; a 10-minute conversation usually clears this up faster than another round of reading alone.

### Re-engagement nudge (quiet student)

Hi **[student name]** — I haven't seen work from you in a bit and wanted to check in before anything piles up. No judgment here; just tell me where you got stuck and let's figure out a plan together. I'm at **[office hours]** or reachable anytime by message.

### The Lottery's compressed 2-week window

This module moves fast: we read, study Jackson's technique, and draft an original story in just two weeks, due before Spring Break on **[date]**. Don't wait for week 2 to start drafting — sketch your story idea this week so next week is revision, not a blank page.

## 10. TEACHER WORKFLOW & WORKLOAD MAP

### A normal week, in order

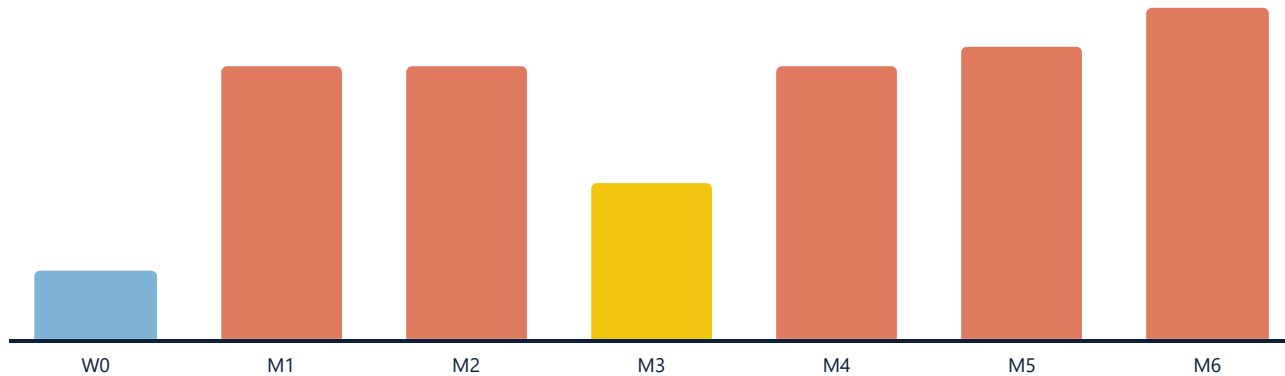
1. Triage the most recent outro-wrapper analytics (15–20 min) — look for confusion clusters and quiet students.
2. Batch-grade Daily Practice and Quick Writes (~30 sec/student each).
3. Batch-read Friday Check-ups; post 2–3 public model-comment replies.
4. Grade any capstone due that week using its rubric in SpeedGrader.
5. Post the weekly announcement (Section 9).
6. Answer messages; hold office hours / VR study hall.

Tier 1 items (Daily Practice, Quick Writes, VR, recitations) cost roughly 0–3 hours/week, batch-graded. Tier 3 capstones spike to 8–12 hours in the week they're due, spread thin in between.

### Heavy weeks to plan around

- **Module 1, Week 10** — Emma essay + VR collage + Q1/Q2 recitation, all at once.
- **Module 5, Week 2** — The Lottery story is due on the same compressed 2-week timeline that ends right before Spring Break; grade promptly so feedback doesn't get lost over the break.
- **Module 6, Week 4** — TKAM Analysis Project due.
- **Module 6, Week 9** — the heaviest week of the year: Creative Scene, Final Essay, shared VR Maycomb, and the year-end recitation all land together. Budget extra grading time here above any other week.

### Workload across the course



Relative facilitator-grading load by module, from the build's own grading-time estimates. Blue = light, gold = moderate, coral = heavy (a major teacher-graded capstone lands in that module). Module 5's bar reflects the same total load as Modules 1/2/4 compressed into half the time; Module 6 stacks three capstones into its final week.

## 11. STANDARDS COVERAGE MAP (CPALMS → MODULES)

Mapped from the course's actual build against the Florida CPALMS course description for M/J Language Arts 3 (#1001070). Codes are for facilitator reference only; they are never shown to students.

### By standard

| STANDARD          | WHAT IT ASKS                                                          | WHERE TAUGHT / ASSESSED                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
|-------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| ELA.8.C.1.2       | Narrative writing, varied transitions, clear POV                      | OOTSP, Lottery, and TKAM Creative Scene (all imitative narrative writing)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| ELA.8.C.1.3       | Argue a position, rebut a counterclaim                                | All 5 Major-Works essays (objection-and-reply is built into every one)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| ELA.8.C.1.4       | Expository writing across multiple sources                            | <b>GAP</b> No assignment currently asks students to synthesize multiple outside sources; TKAM's Analysis Project is single-text analytical, not multi-source expository.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| ELA.8.C.1.5       | Revise from feedback                                                  | Peer review + teacher conference built into every essay/story cycle                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| ELA.8.C.2.1       | Present information orally, supporting a central idea                 | <b>ADDRESSED 2026-07-16</b> Added "Malacandra Speaks" (OOTSP, Week 5-6): students write and deliver an original, imitative-of-Lewis in-character monologue via VR, teacher-graded on a 3-criterion rubric (Voice & Style Imitation / Original Content & Creativity / Delivery). This is now an original student composition delivered aloud, not memorized-passage recitation.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| ELA.8.C.3.1       | Grammar/conventions incl. active/passive voice, semicolons, verb mood | Two grammar lessons/week, taught through author technique; <b>[VERIFY]</b> confirm semicolons and passive/active voice specifically appear somewhere in the 70+ grammar lessons, not just "grammar as craft" generally.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| ELA.8.C.4.1       | Research using multiple reliable sources                              | <b>PARTIALLY ADDRESSED 2026-07-16</b> Added a 2-lesson Research Skills mini-unit (Emma, Week 9): finding sources (JSTOR/library databases named as real examples), primary vs. secondary sources, judging credibility, and MLA quoting/paraphrasing/summarizing/weaving, plus a "Build & Download Your Paragraph" practice tool. The Week 10 Final Essay now requires at least one cited outside source. This is Semester 1 only (Emma); the essay requires one source, not several, so full multi-source synthesis is still more squarely a C.1.4 gap (below). A second, Semester-2 module project and true multi-source work are planned for a future session, not yet built. |
| ELA.8.C.5.1 / 5.2 | Digital media integration; digital collaboration on writing           | Partially: VR-as-evidence in essays, peer review, M365/OneDrive collaboration                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| ELA.8.R.1.1       | Character/setting/plot interaction                                    | Every module (core close-reading work)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| ELA.8.R.1.2       | 2+ themes and their development                                       | Central-question framing per module; each module's essay argues from more than one thematic thread                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| ELA.8.R.1.3       | Perspective of different characters                                   | Character-analysis quick writes in every module                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| ELA.8.R.1.4       | Poetry: structure, sound, imagery, figurative language                | <b>ADDRESSED 2026-07-16</b> Previously only 1 week/year (Module 3, Whitman). A second poetry week (Module 6, Week 0, "Invictus") now covers rhyme scheme, stanza structure, metaphor, and alliteration in Semester 2.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| ELA.8.R.2.1 / 2.2 | Text features, central ideas (typically informational text)           | <b>[VERIFY]</b> The course is entirely literary/poetic; if CPALMS expects informational-text practice specifically, this may need a short nonfiction supplement. Not flagged as a hard gap since the standard doesn't name a genre explicitly.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| ELA.8.R.2.3       | Rhetorical appeals (logos/ethos/pathos)                               | Essay-writing work across all 5 Major Works essays                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |

| STANDARD                                     | WHAT IT ASKS                                                                    | WHERE TAUGHT / ASSESSED                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
|----------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| ELA.8.R.2.4                                  | Argument development, reasoning types, informal fallacies                       | <b>PARTIALLY ADDRESSED 2026-07-16</b> Added a "Bonus - Spotting the Reasoning" lesson to Emma (Week 2: hasty generalization + circular reasoning, tied to Emma's matchmaking logic), OOTSP (Week 5: false dilemma + appeal to nature, tied to Weston's speech to the Oyarsa), and the Whitman module (false dilemma + appeal to authority, tied to the poem's science-vs-wonder tension). Semester 1 only; Semester 2 (LOTF, The Lottery, TKAM) still lacks equivalent named-fallacy lessons and is planned for a future session. |
| ELA.8.R.3.1                                  | Figurative language / symbolism                                                 | LOTF (conch, fire, painted face), TKAM (mockingbird symbol), Week 0 poem                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| ELA.8.R.3.2                                  | Paraphrase grade-level texts                                                    | The imitative "rewrite in your own words" quick writes across every module                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| ELA.8.R.3.3                                  | Compare/contrast archetypes across texts                                        | <b>GAP</b> Not present anywhere in the current build, despite LOTF and TKAM being rich archetype material.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| ELA.8.R.3.4                                  | Rhetorical devices supporting an appeal                                         | Partial: TKAM's grammar focus names anaphora/antithesis; irony/rhetorical question/zeugma are not explicitly named anywhere                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| ELA.8.V.1.1                                  | Academic vocabulary in speaking/writing                                         | Weekly Word Study across every module                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| ELA.8.V.1.2                                  | Greek/Latin roots and affixes                                                   | <b>PARTIALLY ADDRESSED 2026-07-16</b> Added a "Word Roots" box to all 17 Semester 1 Word Study spots (Emma, OOTSP, Whitman), teaching each week's vocabulary word's classical root (or, honestly, noting when a word is native Old English with no classical root) plus 1-2 related English words. Semester 1 only; Modules 4-6 (Semester 2) still lack this and are planned for a future session.                                                                                                                                |
| ELA.8.V.1.3                                  | Context clues, connotation/denotation                                           | Weekly Word Study "in your own sentence / synonym / expanded" pattern                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| ELA.K12.EE.1.1 / 2.1 / 3.1 / 4.1 / 5.1 / 6.1 | Cite evidence, comprehend complex texts, infer, collaborate, format, voice/tone | All supporting standards; broadly covered through the essay/discussion architecture                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |

### By module (quick reference)

| MODULE               | STANDARDS CARRIED                                                                                      |
|----------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Emma                 | R.1.1, R.1.3, C.1.3, C.1.5, V.1.1, V.1.3, C.3.1, <b>C.4.1 (partial, new), R.2.4 (new), V.1.2 (new)</b> |
| OOTSP                | C.1.2, R.1.1, R.1.3, V.1.1, C.3.1, <b>C.2.1 (new), R.2.4 (new), V.1.2 (new)</b>                        |
| M6 Week 0 (Invictus) | <b>R.1.4 (poetry)</b> , R.3.1, V.1.1                                                                   |
| Whitman (Module 3)   | R.1.4 (poetry), C.1.2, R.3.1, <b>R.2.4 (new), V.1.2 (new)</b>                                          |
| LOTF                 | R.3.1 (symbolism), R.2.4 (partial), C.1.3, C.3.1                                                       |
| The Lottery          | C.1.2, R.3.1, R.3.4 (partial)                                                                          |
| TKAM                 | R.1.1, R.1.3, C.1.2, C.1.3, C.1.4 (partial), R.3.4                                                     |

**Summary for the department (updated 2026-07-16):** Of the original 6 flagged gaps, poetry (R.1.4) was fixed immediately (Module 6 Week 0, "Invictus"). Four more were addressed for **Semester 1 only** in this session's second pass: original oral presentation (C.2.1, OOTSP), research/citation skills (C.4.1, Emma — partial: one outside source, not several), named reasoning types/fallacies (R.2.4, Emma/OOTSP/Whitman), and Greek/Latin roots (V.1.2, all 17 S1 Word Study spots). **Two gaps remain fully open:** true multi-source expository synthesis (C.1.4) and archetype study (R.3.3) — neither has been touched. **Semester 2 (Modules 4-6: LOTF, The Lottery, TKAM) still needs:** a second research/citation module project (planned to mirror Emma's pattern, likely TKAM before its Final Essay), Greek/Latin roots for Modules 4-6 Word Study, and fallacy lessons tied to each text (LOTF's Jack/mob rhetoric, The Lottery's appeal to tradition, TKAM's trial-scene prejudice appeals are the natural fits). None of this Semester 2 work is built yet — it is planned for a future session.

## 12. WHAT MAKES THIS COURSE CLASSICAL & CULTIVATING CULTURE

**What makes it classical:** a direct encounter with six works that have earned a hearing in the Western tradition, read slowly rather than summarized; a memorized repertoire built book by book and actually cited in essays and discussion, not recited for its own sake; imitation as the primary way students learn craft (rewriting Austen's, Lewis's, Jackson's, and Lee's sentences before ever inventing their own); and an argument structure, "state the strongest objection, then answer it," that is *disputatio* in substance without ever being named that to students. The seven virtues run through the texts themselves: Emma's slow path to self-knowledge, the boys' loss of self-government in *Lord of the Flies*, the quiet perseverance of Henley's speaker in *Week 0*, and Atticus's courage in *TKAM*.

**Cultivating culture asynchronously:** your public discussion replies are the clearest tool you have for building a real intellectual community without a live classroom — name a student's good thinking by name, not just "great post." Weekly announcements that show your own curiosity about the week's question do more than any policy reminder. Keep the virtue thread visible: when *Week 0* asks what it costs to remain yourself under hard circumstances, say so again when Atticus faces Maycomb three weeks later. Treat every piece of feedback as an act of relationship with a specific student, not a transaction.

## 13. SENSITIVE-CONTENT FLAGS & FAMILY/STUDENT SCRIPTS

**[VERIFY]:** none of these flags currently exist inside the built course itself (no module carries a warning page or teacher note). The flags and scripts below are written fresh from the texts themselves; review and adjust before use.

### Module 4 — Lord of the Flies

**Where:** Weeks 5 and 7. **What:** the novel depicts the death of two children (Simon, killed by the group in a frenzy; Piggy, killed with a boulder) and a manhunt for a third. The violence is central to the book's argument, not incidental.

**Suggested family/student script:** "In the next few weeks, your student's reading in Lord of the Flies includes two violent deaths among the boys on the island. This is the turning point the whole novel builds toward, and it's central to the essay your student will write about what remains of us when the structures of civilization fall away. If you'd like to talk with your student about it in advance, or have any questions about how we'll discuss it in class, please reach out to me at **[contact]**."

### Module 5 — The Lottery

**Where:** the story's final week. **What:** the story ends with a community stoning one of its own members to death, revealed gradually rather than announced. The shock is the point of the craft study (compression, buried foreshadowing).

**Suggested script:** "This short module centers on Shirley Jackson's 'The Lottery,' a story whose ending involves a community ritually killing one of its own members. It's a brief, carefully controlled piece often taught for exactly this reason: it asks what evil can hide inside an unquestioned tradition. We'll discuss it directly and thoughtfully. Questions welcome anytime at **[contact]**."

### Module 6 — To Kill a Mockingbird

**Where:** throughout, intensifying at the trial (Weeks 5–7) and its aftermath. **What:** the novel is set in the Jim Crow-era South and depicts racial injustice directly, including a false accusation against a Black man, period-accurate racist language used by characters (not by the narration approvingly), courtroom testimony about an alleged assault, a mob scene outside the jail, and the death of a character near the novel's end.

**Suggested script:** "Our final novel this year, To Kill a Mockingbird, is set in the segregated American South and confronts racial injustice head-on, including language from that era that is offensive by design; the novel does not endorse it, and neither will our discussion. The trial at the book's center is difficult material, handled with care, and it's the foundation of the course's closing essay on what justice costs. I'm glad to talk through how we'll approach it, or answer any questions, at **[contact]**."

### Module 1 — Emma

**Where:** throughout. **What:** mild social cruelty and class snobbery (Emma's treatment of Miss Bates at Box Hill is the sharpest moment); no violence or content requiring advance notice. Flagged here only for completeness.